MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

DevOps / Infrastructure Engineering | CI/CD, Kubernetes & Terraform

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer transitioning into DevOps and platform engineering, with 7 years of experience and the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, ephemeral environments, Kubernetes deployments, and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral test environments used by three product teams. Hands-on experience building Docker/Helm-based, namespace-level Kubernetes deployments on a shared cluster; the platform team operates the cluster. This experience is complemented by a personal k3s and GitOps homelab and Terraform infrastructure work. Experienced in improving pipeline performance and documenting technical processes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Professional: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level deployments), Python, Bash, Linux, PostgreSQL, Grafana, Java (test code), SQL, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman, Git

Personal projects: Terraform, k3s, Argo CD, Loki, Traefik, cert-manager, Ansible (basic), AWS basics (EC2, S3; personal learning), Hetzner

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw
2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Profiled and improved pipelines by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end testing; reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster. Each environment includes the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and is automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Built test-result collection and Grafana dashboards to identify flaky tests by team.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding; authored an internal CI guide used in team onboarding; owned pipeline and ephemeral-environment changes serving three product teams (~25 developers).
- Deploy Helm-based test environments with namespace-level access on a shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated approaches.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, reproducing bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Set up a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Configured Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS certificate management; deployed Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments deployed via Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI.
- Enabled QA and product reviewers to assess changes before merge, with end-to-end tests running against each environment.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health *2023*

- Collected test results from CI into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests per team.
- Flaky rate fell from 7% to below 2% after teams started fixing the top offenders.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — preparation in progress; exam scheduled January 2027 (not yet certified).

Terraform Associate — practice tests completed; certification not taken.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mentored two QA interns in 2023.

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)